

DAVID ORVEK

Curriculum Vitae

EDUCATION

Indiana University

Ph.D. in Music Theory 2025

Minors in Music History and Guitar Performance

Dissertation: [“Experiencing the Music of Brian Ferneyhough”](#)

Advisor: Andrew Mead

The Ohio State University

M.A. in Music Theory 2019

Thesis: [“Generalized Transformational Voice-Leading Systems”](#)

Advisor: David Clampitt

Southern Adventist University

B.S. in Music Theory and Literature, *summa cum laude* 2016

Honors thesis: [“Ex Nihilo: An Inquiry into the Nature of Musical Composition”](#)

Advisors: J. Bruce Ashton and Daniel Maxwell

TEACHING POSITIONS

Butler University

Lecturer in Music Theory Fall 2024–present

Instructor of Music Theory (full time) Spring 2023–Spring 2024

Adjunct Instructor of Music Theory Fall 2022

Indiana University

Graduate Associate Instructor Fall 2019–Spring 2022 & Summer 2023

The Ohio State University

Graduate Teaching Associate Fall 2017–Spring 2019

Southern Adventist University

Teacher’s Assistant Fall 2014–Fall 2016

COURSES TAUGHT

Butler University

Graduate

Analysis of Music since 1900 Spring 2025
 Master's-level seminar on post-tonal music

Analysis of Tonal Music Spring 2024
 Master's-level seminar on tonal music

Graduate Music Theory Review Fall 2023
 Remedial written theory course for graduate students

Undergraduate

Aural Skills 1 Fall 2025
 Core aural skills course for undergraduates focused on aural skills fundamentals

Aural Skills 3 Fall 2022, 2024, 2025
 Core aural skills course for undergraduates focused on chromatic harmony

Form and Analysis Fall 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025
 Upper-level undergraduate survey of form in tonal and post-tonal music

Counterpoint Spring 2023, 2025
 Upper-level undergraduate introduction to modal and tonal counterpoint

Music Theory 4 Spring 2023, 2024, 2025
 Core written theory course for undergraduates focused on post-tonal music

Music Theory 3 Fall 2023, 2024
 Core written theory course for undergraduates focused on analysis and writing

Music Theory 2 Spring 2023, 2024
 Core written theory course for undergraduates focused on chromatic harmony and form

Indiana University

Instructor of Record

Written Theory Review for Graduate Students Summer 2023
 Remedial written theory course for graduate students

Musical Skills IV Summer 2022
Core aural skills course for undergraduates focused on post-tonal music

Musical Skills II Fall 2021, Spring 2022
Core aural skills course for undergraduates focused on diatonic and chromatic harmony

Under Faculty Supervision

Music Theory and Literature IV Spring 2021
Core written theory course for undergraduates surveying music from the late-Classical and Romantic periods

Music Theory and Literature III Fall 2020
Core written theory course for undergraduates surveying music from the Renaissance to the early-Classical period

Music Theory and Literature II Spring 2020
Core written theory course for undergraduates focused on chromatic harmony

Music Theory and Literature I Fall 2019
Core written theory course for undergraduates focused on diatonic harmony

The Ohio State University (under faculty supervision)

Aural Training II Spring 2018, 2019
Core aural skills course for undergraduates focused on diatonic harmony

Aural Training I Fall 2017, 2018
Core aural skills course for undergraduates focused aural skills fundamentals

Music Theory II Spring 2018, 2019
Core written theory course for undergraduates focused on diatonic harmony and form

Music Theory I Fall 2017, 2018
Core written theory course for undergraduates focused on diatonic harmony and form

Southern Adventist University (under faculty supervision)

Instructor (under faculty supervision)

Basic Musicianship Fall 2014
Remedial written theory course for undergraduates

Teacher's Assistant

Music Theory III Fall 2015, 2016

Core written theory course for undergraduates focused on chromatic harmony

Music Theory IV Spring 2016

Core written theory course for undergraduates focused on post-tonal music

Music Theory II Spring 2015

Core written theory course for undergraduates focused on tonal harmony

Music Theory I Fall 2014

Core written theory course for undergraduates focused on tonal harmony

REFEREED PUBLICATIONS

Orvek, David E. ["Ungrading in the Music Theory Classroom: A One-Year Case Study."](#) *Journal of Music Theory Pedagogy* 38 (2024): 45–69.

Orvek, David, and David Clampitt. ["SUM Classes and Quotient Generalized Interval Systems."](#) In *Mathematics and Computation in Music: 8th International Conference, MCM 2022, Atlanta, GA, USA, June 21–24, 2022*, edited by Mariana Montiel, Octavio A. Agustín-Aquino, Francisco Gómez, Jeremy Kastine, Emilio Lluís-Puebla, and Brent Milam, 99–111. Cham: Springer, 2022.

INVITED TALKS

"'Like a Piece of Woven Material': Unity and Organicism in Elizabeth Maconchy's String Quartet No. 11"

Hartt School Music Theory Colloquium — University of Hartford 2022

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND POSTERS

"Experiencing the Music of Brian Ferneyhough"
Society for Music Theory, Minneapolis, MN 2025

"Ungrading in the Music Theory Classroom: A One-Year Case Study"
Pedagogy into Practice, University of Oklahoma 2024

"Ungrading, Trust, and Artificial Intelligence"
Music Theory Pedagogy Interest Group, Denver, CO 2023

"Germaine Tailleferre's Experiment with Serial Composition"
Patterns and Singularities, Indiana University 2023

“SUM Classes and Quotient Generalized Interval Systems” (with David Clampitt)	
Mathematics and Computation in Music, Atlanta, GA	2022
“‘Like a Piece of Woven Material’: Unity and Organicism in Elizabeth Maconchy’s String Quartet No. 11”	
Society for Music Theory, Online	2021
“Schubert, Schoenberg, and Some Extensions to Cohn’s Sum-Class System”	
Society for Music Theory, Online (poster)	2020
South-Central Society for Music Theory, Nashville, TN	2020
“Closural Features in Non-Tonal Music: A Corpus Study of the Music of Schoenberg, Webern, and Berg”	
Indiana University Symposium of Research in Music, Bloomington, IN	2019
“Ex Nihilo: An Inquiry into the Nature of Musical Composition”	
Southern Adventist University Campus Research Day, Collegedale, TN	2016

AWARDS

Commendation for exemplary performance in the PhD oral exam	2022
Indiana University	
<u>Wennerstrom Music Theory Associate Instructor Fellowship</u>	2022
Indiana University	
Annual departmental award for outstanding achievement in teaching	
Graduate Associate Award	2019
The Ohio State University	
Annual departmental award for outstanding achievement in teaching	
Top Achiever Award for Academic Excellence	2016
Southern Adventist University	

RELATED WORK EXPERIENCE

Editorial Assistant: Music Theory Spectrum	2024–present
Curriculum Designer: Music Fundamentals Online	2021
Office Assistant: School of Music, Southern Adventist University	2015–2016

Choral Librarian: School of Music, Southern Adventist University

2014–2016

ADVISING

Butler University*Advisor*

Christian Miller, Butler Summer Institute project

Summer 2025

Cameron Storey, Music Theory Emphasis paper

Spring 2024

Committee Member

Charissa Garrigus, MA Musicology thesis

Spring 2025

INSTITUTIONAL SERVICE

Butler University

Program for Undergraduate Research Committee

Fall 2024–present

SERVICE TO THE FIELD

Vice President: Pi Kappa Lambda, Delta Zeta Chapter

Spring 2026–present

Program Committee: IU Symposium of Research in Music

2022 & 2023

Organizer and Panel Member: Southern Scholars Experiencing Grad School Q & A
Q & A session for undergraduates interested in graduate school

2021

Music Theory Midwest Technology Committee

2020–2023 (chair 2021–2023)

Co-Editor: Indiana Theory Review, vols. [37](#) & [38](#)

2020–2023

Treasurer: Graduate Theory Association, Indiana University

2020–2021

RELATED SKILLS

Programming

Python, Music21, Humdrum, Bash, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP

Languages

German (novice), French (novice)